

The Bresciano Classification of Ideologies

Ideologies as Thermodynamic Phases of Social Systems

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Abstract

Ideologies are traditionally analyzed as political, moral, or economic doctrines. This paper proposes a fundamentally different framework: ideologies are interpreted as thermodynamic phase states of social systems operating under constraints of energy, entropy, narrative cohesion, and temporal irreversibility. We show that liberalism, socialism, Keynesianism, authoritarianism, populism, technocracy, and revolutionary movements correspond to distinct metastable or unstable regimes in a common phase space. Ideological change is not primarily driven by persuasion, but by phase transitions triggered when entropy, loss, and realizability exceed narrative capacity. This classification unifies political theory with irreversible thermodynamics and provides a post-ideological descriptive model of civilizational dynamics.

1. Introduction

Political ideologies are usually treated as competing belief systems or normative prescriptions. However, historical observation reveals that ideologies rise and collapse in patterns that resemble physical phase transitions rather than rational adoption.

This suggests that ideologies may not be primary causal agents, but emergent macrostates of deeper structural variables.

This paper proposes that ideologies are **thermodynamic phases of social systems**, governed by:

- Energy throughput
- Entropy of coordination
- Loss tolerance
- Narrative cohesion

- Temporal reversibility illusion
- Realizability density

Within this framework, ideologies are not chosen. They are entered.

2. Fundamental Variables

We define the state of a social system by the vector:

$$\Sigma(t) = \{E(t), S(t), L(t), T(t), R(t), N(t)\}$$

Where:

- E : energetic throughput (production, labor, resources)
- S : entropy of coordination (institutional friction, corruption, complexity)
- L : loss tolerance
- T : perceived temporal reversibility
- R : realizability density
- N : narrative cohesion

Ideologies correspond to **stable or metastable attractors** in this state space.

3. Ideological Phases

3.1 Liberal Phase

$$E_{high}, \quad S_{moderate}, \quad T_{illusion} \gg 0, \quad L_{denied}$$

Losses are considered local and correctable. Stability is maintained by deferred entropy and unrealized loss.

Failure mode: temporal insolvency and financial singularity.

3.2 Socialist Phase

$$E_{constrained}, \quad S_{enforced\ low}, \quad L \rightarrow 0$$

Loss is morally prohibited. Entropy suppression produces throughput collapse.

Failure mode: structural stagnation.

3.3 Keynesian Phase

$$E_{buffered}, \quad S_{managed}, \quad L_{socialized}$$

Losses are redistributed across time and population.

Failure mode: debt accumulation singularity.

3.4 Authoritarian Phase

$$S_{internal} \downarrow, \quad S_{external} \uparrow, \quad N_{forced}$$

Entropy is exported through repression and coercion.

Failure mode: violent phase transition.

3.5 Populist Phase

$$N \gg E, \quad T_{illusion} \uparrow\uparrow$$

Narrative energy exceeds material support.

Failure mode: abrupt narrative collapse.

3.6 Technocratic Phase

$$S_{modeled}, \quad T_{simulated}, \quad R_{underestimated}$$

Reality is approximated by models. Reversibility is assumed through computation.

Failure mode: model–reality divergence singularity.

3.7 Revolutionary Phase

$$S_{reset}, \quad L_{explosive}, \quad T_{forced} = 0$$

History is assumed restartable.

Failure mode: rapid emergence of new metastable ideology.

3.8 Post-Ideological (Bresciano) Phase

$$L_{accepted}, \quad T_{irreversible}, \quad R_{acknowledged}, \quad N_{honest}$$

No ideology claims reversibility or permanence.

This is not a political doctrine, but a descriptive equilibrium acknowledging physical limits.

4. Law of Ideological Phase Transition

Societies do not change ideology by persuasion.

They change ideology when entropy, loss, and temporal constraints exceed narrative capacity.

Formally:

$$\frac{d\Sigma}{dt} > \frac{dN}{dt} \Rightarrow \text{Phase Transition}$$

5. Ideologies as Metastable Narratives

Ideologies do not fail because they are wrong.

They fail because they exhaust their thermodynamic support.

Truth is irrelevant to phase stability.

Only entropy, energy, and time matter.

6. Historical Interpretation

Major ideological shifts of the 20th and 21st centuries correspond directly to:

- Energy regime changes
- Demographic entropy
- Financial realizability saturation
- Narrative exhaustion

This explains why ideological debates rarely prevent ideological collapse.

7. Implications

This framework implies:

- Political persuasion is thermodynamically secondary.
 - Ideologies are symptoms, not causes.
 - Collapse is not moral failure, but physical necessity.
 - Post-ideological realism is not cynicism, but thermodynamic maturity.
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8. Conclusion

Ideologies are not competing worldviews.

They are **phase states of civilization under irreversible time**.

The future will not belong to a new ideology.

It will belong to systems that acknowledge irreversibility.

9. Final Statement

Ideologies are not beliefs.

They are thermodynamic accommodations to loss, entropy, and time.

Suggested Zenodo Keywords

Thermodynamics of social systems

Ideology as phase transition

Entropy in political systems

Narrative thermodynamics

Post-ideological theory

Temporal irreversibility

Civilizational phase space